or Jordan. There was never a complete overlap among all of the parties. And, of course, Egypt's agenda also had to be taken into account.

One of the greatest worries for Israel was the assessment, maintained for a long period of time, that Jordan would not sign a peace treaty with Israel alone. This assessment was well founded and well reasoned, and was held by players who could not be easily dismissed with a wave of the hand. Another major difficulty stemmed from the presence and role of the radical Islamic organizations in Jordan, first and foremost Hamas. They had been present in Jordan for many years; every time an attack was carried out in Israel and its source was traced back to Jordan, it was seen as additional proof of the belief held by some in the Israeli camp that Jordan would never sign an agreement on its own and that it was impossible to reach an agreement as long as Jordan provided shelter to radical Islamic organizations. Each time Israel complained about the extremist Islamic organizations in Jordan, the answer was: "We will expel them if you want, but if we do then we lose control. They will go to Libya or Algeria, and from there they'll be able to do whatever they want. At least here in Jordan we have full control over them, and we can monitor them, restrict them, and thwart their terrorist plans."

Decision makers in Israel faced a dilemma, in which all the intelligence officers felt that they had a direct relationship with the subject about which they were collecting information. The Israeli intelligence-gathering and assessment bodies had to collect intelligence about Jordan, while at the same time maintaining personal contact with those on whom they had to gather information. The dilemma was whether this personal contact led to better understandings and assessments or whether the personal acquaintance colored the evaluation, leading to biased and inaccurate assessments and analyses of the situation.

The Mossad people believed, in large part on the basis of personal familiarity, that they were on the right track and were talking to people who really wanted peace; they believed that Jordan would agree to sign a peace agreement on its own, subject of course to a few necessary conditions. Other members of the intelligence community, who did not have personal relationships with the Jordanians, were much more suspicious and reserved. The end result showed that the optimists were right, and that is a good thing.